Calculations with the Mean

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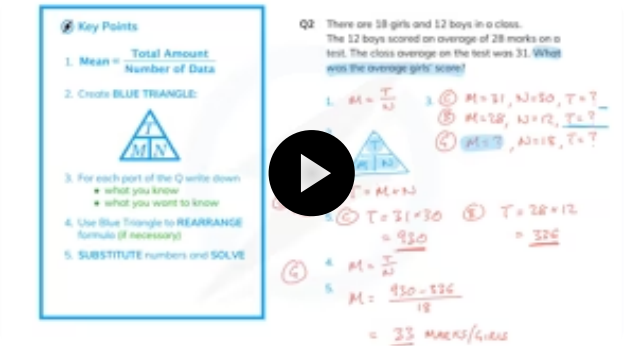

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Calculations with the mean

How do I solve harder problems involving the mean?

Help me understand

- Remember what the mean is
  - **Mean = total of values ÷ number of values**
    - It is a **formula** involving three quantities
    - if you know any two, you can find the other one
- A question may require you to work **backwards** from a **known mean**
  - It helps to rearrange the formula
  - **Total of values = mean × number of values**
- Find the **total** of the values **before and after** to help with question that involve:
  - **missing** values
  - **adding in**, or **taking out**, a value

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

It can help to think of the mean as a formula which you can rearrange.

Worked Example

A class of 24 students has a mean height of 1.56 metres.
A new student joins the class.
The mean height of the class is now 1.57 metres.

Find the height of the new student.

Answer:

Rearrange the formula for mean to get 'total of heights = mean height × number of students'
Find the total of heights before

Total of heights before = 1.56 × 24 = 37.44

Find the total of heights after
Remember there are now 25 students

Total of heights after = 1.57 × 25 = 39.25

The height of the new student is the difference of the two totals above

39.25 - 37.44 = 1.81

The height of the new student is 1.81 metres

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